The Famous London Cholera Map (1854) - StoryMap



Open the London Cholera map you have already created. It should depict three layers - Cholera Cases, Water Pumps and Snow's Cholera Map. Refer back to the case study if needed.

Next, we create a simple StoryMap to tell the story of Dr. Snow's map. Note the 9 dots matrix at the top of your work area. Select 'StoryMaps'. A new tab should open into the StoryMap editor. In the upper right hand corner, select '+Create / Story' and 'you should now be in the StoryMap editor. It is very simple to use and a great tool for telling your story.

Begin by giving your story a descriptive title, like 'London Cholera - 1854' or something interesting. In the short introduction or summary box, enter a one sentence description, like "The story of Dr. John Snow's famous Cholera map". Your work is automatically saved in draft form as you make your edits.

Find and download an image that creates an interesting impression of the cholera epidemic and record the source of the image (which we will use later for attribution). This will become your cover image. When ready, select 'Add cover image or video' and upload your image. You are well on the way!

At the top of the work area, select Design and select theme or browse through the 'Featured themes gallery' to find one that is appropriate for this most grim story. Turn on 'Credits'.

Wherever you see a plus sign in green, can add content. At the first green plus sign (Tell your story), select Text, and add paragraph or two explaining the situation. Some like (or copy this one): "Many people died in Europe during the deadly and recurring cholera epidemics. In times before modern bacteriology, medicine, epidemiology and public health, there was great debate and misunderstanding about the causes and spread of this disease."

Add text again and add a second paragraph, like this (or copy this one):
"At the time, it was generally assumed, and accepted, that cholera was an airborne disease (miasma). Given the open sewers in London (and elsewhere), the presence of livestock, the crowded conditions, and the general lack of proper sanitation, there was plenty of reason to believe the miasma theory. Dr. John Snow, a resident of the area, thought otherwise."

Next, add your Cholera Map. Under the plus sign, select Map and add your Cholera map. If you have created other maps, they will also show up here. When you have selected your map, you can decide which layers you want to appear. For example, you could deselect the Cholera Cases layer and only show the original map and the pump locations. Do so and add some basic text below the map to explain it.

Select the Preview option at the top of the map to preview your work at any time. Choose the small x at the bottom right to return to the design/edit mode.

Next, add your Cholera map once again, but also select the Cholera Cases layer. This should show your heat map. Add some descriptive text.

Note: If you make any changes to your original Cholera map in ArcGIS, these changes will be reflected in your StoryMap the next time you load it.

Add a credit for the image you downloaded and any other content or finishing touches you would like to complete your basic StoryMap.

When you are ready to share your StoryMap, select Publish. You can keep your map private for now.

Assignment: Ask the TAs to mark you for credit.